Week 6 | Real-book guide

November 16 to 20 | Small contributions build toward a shared goal after a hard event.

One book, all subjects

A Chair for My Mother | Small contributions build toward a shared goal after a hard event. Math: Use coins, counters or measurement strips to model repeated contributions toward a goal. Science: Test a small chair or cart on ramps and surfaces; describe how the energy or speed changes. Social studies: Identify family, neighbor and community support and explain how each action helps. Finish: Create a goal jar with picture contributions and a beginning-middle-end celebration scene.

Grade 3 | A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare

one copy of A Chair for My Mother; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from A Chair for My Mother to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-16: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-17: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-18: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-19: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-20: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare

one copy of A Chair for My Mother; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from A Chair for My Mother to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-16: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-17: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-18: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-19: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-20: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.